

Code of Conduct and Workplace Ethics

Establishes expected standards of professional behavior, integrity, and conduct for all employees.

Document No.	HR-POL-001	Version	5.0
Effective Date	01 January 2026	Policy Owner	Chief Human Resources Officer
Applicability	All employees, contractors, and interns	Review Cycle	Annual

1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct sets out the minimum standards of behavior expected from every person engaged by the organization, regardless of role, level, or location. Violation of this code may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

2. Core Principles

- Integrity: Act honestly in all business dealings, internal and external.
- Respect: Treat colleagues, clients, and vendors with dignity regardless of background.
- Accountability: Take ownership of decisions, actions, and their consequences.
- Confidentiality: Protect proprietary, personal, and client information at all times.
- Compliance: Adhere to all applicable laws, regulations, and internal policies.

3. Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination

The organization maintains a zero-tolerance stance toward harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind, based on gender, race, religion, caste, disability, sexual orientation, age, or any other protected characteristic. This includes verbal, physical, visual, and digital forms of harassment, including conduct occurring on official communication channels outside of working hours.

3.1 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

In compliance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, the organization has constituted an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) at each location with more than 10 employees. Complaints may be raised confidentially via posh-committee@company.example or through the anonymous ethics hotline. The ICC is obligated to complete inquiry within 90 days of a complaint being filed.

4. Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any personal, financial, or familial relationship that could reasonably be perceived to influence business decisions, including but not limited to: hiring or managing a relative, holding a financial stake in a vendor or competitor, or accepting outside employment that competes with the organization's business.

Disclosures must be filed annually via the Conflict of Interest Declaration Form, and immediately upon any material change.

5. Gifts, Entertainment, and Anti-Bribery

Employees may not solicit or accept gifts, favors, or entertainment from vendors, clients, or partners exceeding INR 5,000 in value in a calendar year without prior disclosure to the Ethics Office. Cash or cash-equivalent gifts (vouchers, gift cards) of any value must be declined. Facilitation payments and bribes of any kind, to any party, are strictly prohibited and constitute grounds for immediate termination and potential legal action.

6. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees must not disclose confidential business information, trade secrets, customer data, or employee personal data to any unauthorized party, during or after employment. This obligation survives termination of employment indefinitely for trade secrets, and for a period of 2 years for general confidential business information, as specified in the employee's confidentiality undertaking.

7. Use of Company Assets and Systems

Company-provided laptops, email, communication tools, and other digital assets are to be used primarily for business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with productivity, violate any law, or involve accessing inappropriate content. All activity on company systems may be monitored in accordance with the IT Acceptable Use Policy (IT-POL-002).

8. Social Media Conduct

Employees are personally responsible for content they post on social media. Employees must not disclose confidential company information, speak on behalf of the organization without authorization, or post content that could be construed as harassing or discriminatory toward colleagues, even from personal accounts.

9. Reporting Violations

Employees who witness or experience a violation of this Code are strongly encouraged to report it through their manager, HR Business Partner, or the anonymous ethics hotline at 1800-XXX-XXXX. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is itself a violation of this Code and will be treated with equal seriousness.

10. Disciplinary Action Framework

Severity	Example	Typical Action
Minor	Repeated tardiness, minor policy oversight	Verbal warning, coaching
Moderate	Breach of confidentiality (non-malicious), conflict of interest non-disclosure	Written warning, mandatory training
Serious	Harassment, falsification of records, repeated moderate violations	Suspension, final written warning
Severe	Fraud, bribery, sexual harassment (substantiated), theft	Termination, potential legal referral

This document supersedes Code of Conduct v4.3 dated 01 January 2025. Acknowledgement of this policy is mandatory annually via the HRMS.